

KEY TOPIC 1 CHRONOLOGICAL ENQUIRY SEQUENCE • 1945–1963**The Birth of the State of Israel, 1945–1963***British Mandate Collapse, King David Hotel, UN Resolution 181, The 1948 War, The Nakba & The Suez Crisis***HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD • 14 MAY 1948****GPO-D597-087****Proclamation of the State of Israel, Tel Aviv Museum of Art**

Rudi Weissenstein (1910–1969) • David Ben-Gurion, Executive Head of the World Zionist Organisation, reads the Declaration of Independence beneath the portrait of Theodor Herzl on 5 Iyyar 5708. Registered in the State of Israel Government Press Office archive under Accession Shelfmark GPO-D597-087.

HISTORICAL PRIMARY SOURCE**EDEXCEL PAPER 2 MASTER ARCHIVE****PUPIL WORKBOOK & ASSESSMENT****EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY • PAPER 2: CONFLICT IN THE MIDDLE EAST, 1945–1995 • KEY TOPIC 1**

NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY SPECIFICATION • KEY TOPIC 1 CONTENT**OFFICIAL SPECIFICATION CONTENT****1. THE BRITISH WITHDRAWAL & ISRAEL**

- Conflicting interests and demands of Jews and Arabs within the British Mandate.
- Key events leading to the end of the British Mandate, partition and the creation of Israel, including the significance of the bombing of the King David Hotel and UN Resolution 181.
- Key events of the Arab-Israeli war (1948–49).

2. AFTERMATH OF THE 1948–49 WAR

- Territorial changes and their impact.
- The refugee status of Palestinian Arabs.
- The creation of the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) and the Law of Return (1950).
- US aid to Israel.
- Israel's relations with Egypt.

3. INCREASED TENSION, 1955–63

- Nasser and Egypt's leadership of the Arab world.
- The events and significance of Israeli attacks on Gaza in 1955 and Sinai in 1956.
- The events and significance of the Suez Crisis (1956), including the formation of the United Arab Republic (UAR) in 1958.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: IMPERIAL PLEDGES, INSURGENCY & PARTITION (1917–1947)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding Key Topic boxes below.

NOV 1917 • The Balfour Declaration & Contradictory British Promises

Key Topic 1.1

British Foreign Secretary Arthur Balfour writes to Lord Rothschild promising British support for the establishment of a "national home for the Jewish people" in Palestine. This directly contradicts Britain's 1915 pledge to Sharif Hussein of Mecca and the secret 1916 Sykes-Picot Agreement dividing the Middle East with France.

JULY 1946 • The Bombing of the King David Hotel, Jerusalem

Key Topic 1.2

Disguised as milkmen, militants from the Zionist paramilitary group Irgun, led by Menachem Begin, detonate 350kg of explosives in the basement of the King David Hotel. The blast collapses the entire south-west wing housing British military headquarters, killing 91 British, Arab, and Jewish staff.

NOV 1947 • UN Resolution 181 (The Palestine Partition Plan)

Key Topic 1.3

The United Nations General Assembly votes 33 to 13 to terminate the British Mandate and partition Palestine into separate Arab and Jewish states, with Jerusalem placed under international trusteeship (Corpus Separatum). The Jewish Agency accepts; all Arab nations reject the plan, triggering civil war.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: STATEHOOD, THE NAKBA & THE SUEZ CRISIS (1948–1956)

Instructions: Complete sketches and dual-coding annotations for the war of independence, the displacement of Palestinians, and the 1956 Suez Crisis.

MAY 1948 • Declaration of Independence & The 1948–49 Arab-Israeli War

Key Topic 1.3

On 14 May 1948, David Ben-Gurion proclaims the State of Israel as British forces complete their evacuation. The next day, five Arab states (Egypt, Transjordan, Syria, Iraq, Lebanon) invade. Israel survives initial assaults, re-arms during the June UN truce via Czechoslovakia, and signs armistices along the 1949 Green Line.

1948–1950 • The Palestinian Refugee Crisis (Al-Nakba) & Law of Return

Key Topic 1.4

Approximately 700,000 Palestinian Arabs are displaced into permanent exile (Al-Nakba), supported by the newly formed UNRWA in Gaza, the West Bank, Lebanon, and Syria. Simultaneously, Israel passes the 1950 Law of Return, absorbing over 680,000 Holocaust survivors and Mizrahi Jewish refugees from Arab lands.

OCT–NOV 1956 • The Suez Crisis & The Protocol of Sèvres

Key Topic 1.5

Following Nasser's nationalisation of the Suez Canal, Britain, France, and Israel secretly sign the Protocol of Sèvres. Israel invades the Sinai on 29 October; Britain and France intervene to "separate the combatants" and seize the canal. US financial ultimatums force a humiliating Anglo-French withdrawal, leaving UNEF peacekeepers in Sinai.

Why did conflicting British wartime promises make conflict in Palestine inevitable?

Key Topic 1.1: Imperial Origins, Conflicting Promises & Mandate Tensions (1915–1945)

Key Specification Focus: Conflicting interests and demands of Jews and Arabs within the British Mandate; the McMahon-Hussein Correspondence (1915), the secret Sykes-Picot Agreement (1916), the Balfour Declaration (1917), and the 1939 British White Paper.

• CHRONOLOGICAL LESSON SPINE & STRUCTURED NOTE-TAKING

5 TURNING POINTS • ACTIVE RECALL

STAGE 1 1915–1916

The McMahon-Hussein Correspondence

STAGE 2 May 1916

The Secret Sykes-Picot Agreement

STAGE 3 November 1917

The Balfour Declaration

STAGE 4 1920–1936

The British Mandate & Rising Immigration

STAGE 5 1936–1939

The Arab Revolt & The 1939 White Paper

• CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY & HISTORICAL DISTINCTION

TERMINOLOGY

Explain the fundamental historical distinction between **Zionism** and **Arab Nationalism**. Why did both movements consider the land of Palestine their rightful national territory, and why did this make peaceful compromise under the British Mandate nearly impossible?

KT1.1: Imperial Origins & Contradictory Pledges

DISCIPLINARY LESSON NOTES • CHRONOLOGICAL SYNTHESIS

Instructions: Use this open note-taking canvas to record teacher direct instruction, annotate key causal links, and synthesize the 5 milestones on facing Page 4.

[illegible]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

PFC Guidance: Identify a clear consequence (e.g. Arab sense of betrayal or international legitimisation of a Jewish homeland), cite specific factual detail, and explain its long-term impact on tensions in Palestine.

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT • 8 MARKS

McMahon-Hussein (1915) • Sharif Hussein • Sykes-Picot (1916) • Balfour Declaration (1917) • Arthur Balfour • Lord Rothschild • "national home" • League of Nations Mandate (1922) • Yishuv • Arab Nationalism • Jewish immigration

KT1.1: Imperial Origins & Contradictory Pledges (1915–1945)

**INDEPENDENT PRACTICE • EXTENDED EXAM
RESPONSE**

[illegible]**TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2-3**

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.1). In Milestone 1, sketch the contradictory British pledges and the imperial boundary line separating British and French mandate zones.

BAND 4 CHECKLIST [7-8M]:

- ☐ Accurate & relevant details deployed ☐ Analytical progression sustained throughout

- ☐
- Explicit causal connectives used

Mark: [/ 8]

Why did Britain abandon its Mandate in Palestine and hand the problem to the UN?

Key Topic 1.2: The Collapse of the British Mandate & UN Partition (1945–1947)

Key Specification Focus: Conflicting interests after World War Two; Jewish insurgency (Irgun and Lehi); the bombing of the King David Hotel (July 1946); British economic and military exhaustion; the SS Exodus affair (1947); and UNSCOP recommendations.

• CHRONOLOGICAL LESSON SPINE & STRUCTURED NOTE-TAKING

5 TURNING POINTS • ACTIVE RECALL

STAGE 1 1945–1946

Post-War Holocaust Survivors & The Insurgency

STAGE 2 22 July 1946

The King David Hotel Bombing

STAGE 3 February 1947

Britain Hands Palestine to the United Nations

STAGE 4 July 1947

The SS Exodus Affair & Global Outcry

STAGE 5 29 November 1947

UN Resolution 181 (The Partition Plan)

• CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY & HISTORICAL DISTINCTION

TERMINOLOGY

Explain the crucial historical difference between a **League of Nations Mandate** and **United Nations Partition**. Why did the British government conclude by February 1947 that the Mandate was entirely unworkable, prompting them to refer Palestine to the UN?

KT1.2: Collapse of the Mandate & UN Partition (1945–1947) **DISCIPLINARY LESSON NOTES • CHRONOLOGICAL SYNTHESIS**

DISCIPLINARY LESSON NOTES • CHRONOLOGICAL SYNTHESIS

Instructions: Use this open note-taking canvas to record teacher direct instruction, annotate key causal links, and synthesize the 5 milestones on facing Page 8.

[illegible]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

PFC Guidance: Focus on the 91 deaths, the destruction of British military headquarters, and the hardening of British domestic public opinion demanding troop withdrawal from Palestine.

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT • 8 MARKS

Structure across two distinct analytical aspects: • Destruction of British Military HQ & Security Breakdown • Domestic Economic Exhaustion & Handover to the UN

3. EVALUATIVE SUMMARY: UN REFERRAL

3. EVALUATIVE SUMMARY - ON REFERENCE
Assess why Foreign Secretary Bevin concluded Britain could not reconcile Zionist and Arab demands, forcing the February 1947 handover to UNSCOP.

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

King David Hotel (July 1946) • Irgun • Menachem Begin • 91 casualties • British Military HQ • Secretariat • Clement Attlee • Ernest Bevin • financial cost • 100,000 troops • UNSCOP • February 1947 handover

KT1.2: Collapse of the Mandate & UN Partition (1945–1947) INDEPENDENT PRACTICE • EXTENDED EXAM RESPONSE[illegible]**TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2-3**

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.2). In Milestone 2, sketch the shattered south-west wing of the King David Hotel and the barbed wire perimeter around British administrative zones.

BAND 4 CHECKLIST [7-8M]:

- ☐ Accurate & relevant details deployed ☐ Analytical progression sustained throughout

- ☐ Explicit causal connectives used

Mark: [/ 8]

"Write with forensic detail: dates, casualties, and causal mechanisms turn notes into top marks."

How was the State of Israel established and defended during the 1948–49 War?

Key Topic 1.3: UN Resolution 181, Independence & The 1948–49 War (1947–1949)

Key Specification Focus: UN Resolution 181 (Partition Plan, November 1947); outbreak of civil war; the British evacuation; David Ben-Gurion's declaration of Israel (14 May 1948); invasion by five Arab armies; the UN truces; and the 1949 Armistice Agreements (Green Line).

• CHRONOLOGICAL LESSON SPINE & STRUCTURED NOTE-TAKING

5 TURNING POINTS • ACTIVE RECALL**STAGE 1** Dec 1947 – May 1948**Communal Civil War & British Evacuation****STAGE 2** 14 May 1948**David Ben-Gurion Proclaims the State of Israel****STAGE 3** 15 May 1948**Invasion by Five Arab Armies****STAGE 4** June–July 1948**The First UN Truce & The Czech Arms Supply****STAGE 5** 1949**The Rhodes Armistice Agreements & The Green Line**

• CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY & HISTORICAL DISTINCTION

TERMINOLOGY

Explain the crucial historical difference between the **1947 UN Partition Borders (Resolution 181)** and the **1949 Armistice Green Line**. How did Israel's military victory in 1948–49 transform the map of the Middle East?

KT1.3: UN Resolution 181 & The 1948-49 War (1947-1949)

DISCIPLINARY LESSON NOTES • CHRONOLOGICAL SYNTHESIS

Instructions: Use this open note-taking canvas to record teacher direct instruction, annotate key causal links, and synthesize the 5 milestones on facing Page 12.

[illegible]

• QUESTION 1: EXPLAIN ONE CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one consequence of United Nations Resolution 181 (November 1947).

PFC Guidance: Detail how the UN vote to partition Palestine granted international legitimacy to the creation of a Jewish state, but provoked immediate violent rejection and civil war by Palestinian Arabs.

Sentence Stems: One consequence of UN Resolution 181 was... Specifically, the UN voted to allocate 55% of Palestine to a Jewish state, which resulted in... Consequently, civil conflict broke out immediately between...

Question 2: Narrative Account [8 marks • 12 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT • 8 MARKS

Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the 1948–49 Arab-Israeli War from the declaration of the State of Israel to the 1949 Armistice Agreements. [8 marks]

You may use the following in your answer: • David Ben-Gurion's Declaration of Independence (14 May 1948) • The first UN truce and Czechoslovakian arms shipments (June 1948) • *You must also use information of your own.*

1. PHASE 1: ARAB INVASION

Detail Ben-Gurion's 14 May declaration, the 15 May invasion by 5 Arab armies, and early defensive survival by Haganah/IDF.

2. PHASE 2: TURNING POINT TRUCE

Explain how the June 1948 UN truce enabled Israel to import Czechoslovakian weapons and unify command under IDF.

3. PHASE 3: ISRAELI OFFENSIVES

Detail Operations Dani and Yoav breaking Arab armies, leading to the 1949 Rhodes Armistice Agreements and Green Line.

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES:

The war commenced on 14 May 1948 when... • Immediately on 15 May, five Arab armies... • The vital turning point occurred during the June truce when... • With Czechoslovakian weapons secured, the IDF launched... • Consequently, Arab armies were pushed back because... • Ultimately, the 1949 Armistices established...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

David Ben-Gurion • 14 May 1948 • Tel Aviv Museum • Arab invasion • Egypt, Jordan, Syria, Iraq, Lebanon • Arab Legion • Glubb Pasha • June 1948 truce • Count Folke Bernadotte • Czech arms deal • Operation Dani • Operation Yoav • 1949 Armistices • Green Line

Task: Begin your analytical response below and continue onto facing Page 15 for full timed response:

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3 Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.3). In Milestones 3 & 4, sketch the UN Partition map divisions and the five Arab invasion routes crossing Israel's borders.	
BAND 4 CHECKLIST [7–8M]: ☐ Explicit causal connectives used	☐ Accurate & relevant details deployed ☐ Analytical progression sustained throughout
Mark: [] / 8	

Why did the aftermath of the 1948–49 War create a permanent refugee crisis and an armed Israeli state?

Key Topic 1.4: The Refugee Crisis (Nakba), Israeli Statehood & Border Friction (1949–1955)

Key Specification Focus: Territorial changes and the Green Line; the refugee status of approximately 700,000 Palestinian Arabs (Al-Nakba); creation of UNRWA; the Israeli Law of Return (1950); the creation of the IDF; US financial aid; and early relations with Egypt.

• CHRONOLOGICAL LESSON SPINE & STRUCTURED NOTE-TAKING

5 TURNING POINTS • ACTIVE RECALL

STAGE 1 1948–1949

The Palestinian Refugee Crisis (Al-Nakba)

STAGE 2 Dec 1948 – Dec 1949

UN Resolutions 194 & 302 (Founding of UNRWA)

STAGE 3 July 1950

The Israeli Law of Return & Demographic Surge

STAGE 4 1950–1953

Consolidation of the IDF & US Economic Backing

STAGE 5 1950–1954

Fedayeen Infiltration & Disproportionate Reprisals

• CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY & HISTORICAL DISTINCTION

TERMINOLOGY

Explain the crucial historical difference between the **Palestinian Nakba** and the **Israeli Law of Return (1950)**. How did the displacement of Palestinians on one hand and the open-door immigration of global Jews on the other create two totally opposing historical realities?

KT1.4: The Refugee Crisis (Nakba) & New Israeli State (1948–1954)

DISCIPLINARY LESSON NOTES • CHRONOLOGICAL SYNTHESIS

Instructions: Use this open note-taking canvas to record teacher direct instruction, annotate key causal links, and synthesize the 5 milestones on facing Page 16.

[illegible]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

PFC Guidance: Focus on the displacement of approximately 700,000 people, the loss of land, exile into squalid refugee camps in Gaza, the West Bank, Lebanon, and Syria, and their denial of a right of return.

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT • 8 MARKS

Law of Return (1950) • David Ben-Gurion • Jewish diaspora • Holocaust survivors • Displaced Persons camps • Mizrahi Jews • ma'abarot (transit camps) • population doubled • IDF universal conscription • kibbutzim border defense

KT1.4: The Refugee Crisis (Nakba) & New Israeli State (1948–1954) INDEPENDENT PRACTICE • EXTENDED EXAM RESPONSE

INDEPENDENT PRACTICE • EXTENDED EXAM RESPONSE

[illegible]**TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2-3**

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.4). In Milestone 5, sketch the overcrowded UNRWA refugee tents alongside the cargo ships arriving in Haifa with Jewish immigrants.

BAND 4 CHECKLIST [7-8M]:

- ☐ Accurate & relevant details deployed ☐ Analytical progression sustained throughout

- ☐
- Explicit causal connectives used

Mark: [/ 8]

Why did the nationalisation of the Suez Canal trigger an international crisis in 1956?

Key Topic 1.5: Nasser, Border Tension, the Gaza Raid & The Suez Crisis (1955–1963)

Key Specification Focus: Gamal Abdel Nasser and Egypt's leadership of the Arab world; cross-border fedayeen raids; the Israeli raid on Gaza (Feb 1955); the Czech arms deal (1955); the nationalisation of the Suez Canal (July 1956); the secret Protocol of Sèvres; the Sinai campaign; US intervention; and the creation of the United Arab Republic (1958).

• CHRONOLOGICAL LESSON SPINE & STRUCTURED NOTE-TAKING

5 TURNING POINTS • ACTIVE RECALL

STAGE 1 28 February 1955

The Gaza Raid (Operation Black Arrow)

STAGE 2 September 1955

The Czech Arms Deal & Soviet Influence

STAGE 3 26 July 1956

Aswan Loans Cancelled & Suez Canal Nationalised

STAGE 4 22–24 October 1956

The Secret Protocol of Sèvres & Sinai Invasion

STAGE 5 Nov 1956 – Mar 1957

US Ultimatum, Imperial Retreat & UNEF Deployment

• CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY & HISTORICAL DISTINCTION

TERMINOLOGY

Explain the crucial historical difference between **Nationalisation** and **Demilitarisation**. How did Nasser's nationalisation of the Suez Canal in July 1956 lead directly to the demilitarisation of the Sinai Peninsula monitored by UN peacekeepers (UNEF) in 1957?

KT1.5: Nasser, Border Tension & The 1956 Suez Crisis (1955-1958)

DISCIPLINARY LESSON NOTES • CHRONOLOGICAL SYNTHESIS

Instructions: Use this open note-taking canvas to record teacher direct instruction, annotate key causal links, and synthesize the 5 milestones on facing Page 20.

[illegible]

• QUESTION 1: EXPLAIN ONE CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one consequence of the Israeli raid on Gaza (February 1955).

PFC Guidance: Explain how the death of 37 Egyptian soldiers shattered Nasser's illusion of military strength, prompting him to seek Soviet weapons through the 1955 Czech arms deal.

Sentence Stems: One consequence of the Israeli raid on Gaza was Nasser's decision to rearm Egypt with Soviet weapons. In particular, Israeli paratroopers killed 37 Egyptian soldiers, which humiliated Nasser and proved Egyptian weakness. Consequently, Nasser turned to the Soviet bloc and signed the September 1955 Czech arms deal...

Question 2: Narrative Account [8 marks • 12 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT • 8 MARKS

Write a narrative account analysing the events of the 1956 Suez Crisis from the nationalisation of the canal to the withdrawal of Anglo-French forces. [8 marks]

You may use the following in your answer: • President Nasser nationalises the Suez Canal (26 July 1956) • The secret Protocol of Sèvres and Israeli invasion of Sinai (October 1956) • *You must also use information of your own.*

1. PHASE 1: CATALYST & NATIONALISATION Explain US cancellation of Aswan Dam loans, prompting Nasser to nationalise the Suez Canal on 26 July 1956 to fund the dam.	2. PHASE 2: SECRET SÈVRES CONSPIRACY Detail the secret Protocol of Sèvres where Israel invaded Sinai, providing the pretext for Anglo-French paratrooper landings at Port Said.	3. PHASE 3: SUPERPOWER ULTIMATUM Explain Eisenhower's financial threat to collapse sterling, forcing humiliating Anglo-French retreat and deploying UNEF.
ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: <i>The crisis began on 26 July 1956 when President Nasser... • In response, Britain and France secretly allied with Israel through... • On 29 October 1956, the plan unfolded when Israeli forces invaded... • Under the pretext of separating the combatants, Anglo-French paratroopers... • However, US President Eisenhower intervened decisively by... • Consequently, Britain and France were forced into a humiliating retreat, resulting in...</i>		KEY VOCABULARY BANK: Gamal Abdel Nasser • Aswan High Dam • nationalisation • 26 July 1956 • Anthony Eden • Protocol of Sèvres • Operation Musketeer • Sinai Peninsula • Port Said paratroopers • Dwight D. Eisenhower • oil sanctions • run on the pound • UN Emergency Force (UNEF) • United Arab Republic (1958)

Task: Begin your analytical response below and continue onto facing Page 23 for full timed response:

KT1.5: Nasser, Border Tension & The 1956 Suez Crisis (1955–1958) INDEPENDENT PRACTICE • EXTENDED EXAM RESPONSE

INDEPENDENT PRACTICE • EXTENDED EXAM RESPONSE

[illegible]**TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2-3**

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.5). In Milestone 6, sketch the nationalised Suez Canal waterway and the British paratroopers landing at Port Said under US diplomatic pressure.

BAND 4 CHECKLIST [7-8M]:

- ☐ Accurate & relevant details deployed ☐ Analytical progression sustained throughout

- ☐
- Explicit causal connectives used

Mark: [/ 8]

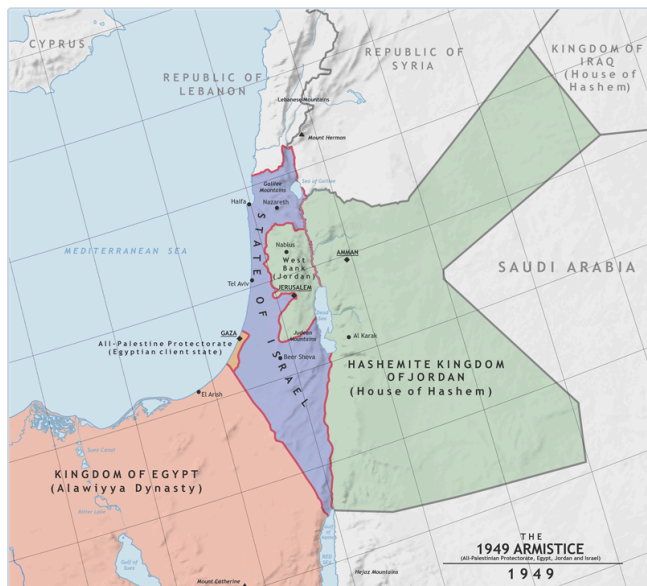
KEY TOPIC 1 CARTOGRAPHIC MASTERCLASS • PARTITION & SUEZ (1947–1956)

Geographical Disciplinary Evidence

1. THE 1949 RHODES ARMISTICE GREEN LINE

MAP ARCHIVE

From the 1947 UN Resolution 181 partition proposal to the 1949 Armistice borders and the Nakba:

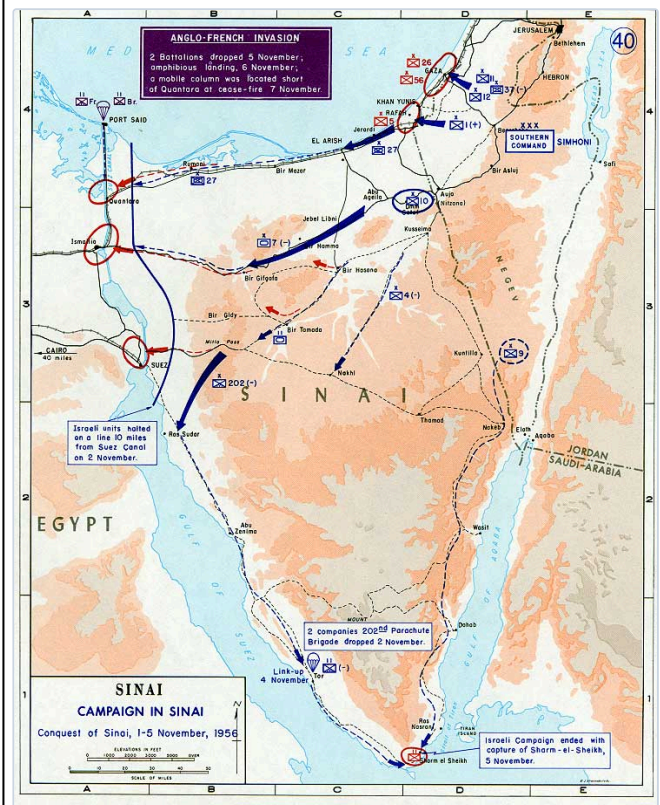


- **UN Resolution 181 (1947):** Allocated 55% to Jewish state, 44% to Arab state, Jerusalem international Corpus Separatum.
- **1948–49 War Outcome:** Israel expanded to secure 79% of Mandate Palestine; Transjordan annexed West Bank; Egypt held Gaza.
- **The Nakba (1948):** 700,000+ Palestinian Arabs displaced; armistice demarcation drawn in green pencil at Rhodes (Green Line).

2. THE 1956 SUEZ CRISIS • SINAI CONQUEST

CAMPAIGN ARCHIVE

Operation Kadesh, the secret Protocol of Sèvres collusion, and the Anglo-French Port Said landings:



- **Protocol of Sèvres:** Secret collusion between Britain, France, and Israel to seize the canal and overthrow President Nasser.
- **100-Hour Blitzkrieg:** Moshe Dayan's IDF swept across Sinai in 100 hours; 202nd Paratroopers dropped at Mitla Pass; took Sharm el-Sheikh.
- **Superpower Intervention:** US President Eisenhower forced Allied withdrawal via financial pressure; UNEF deployed to Sinai.

CARTOGRAPHIC DISCIPLINARY INSIGHT: HOW DID BORDERS & STRATEGIC MARITIME CHOKEPOINTS FUEL CONFLICT?

The armistice boundaries of 1949 created extreme strategic vulnerability: Israel's coastal waist near Tel Aviv was only 9 miles wide, while over 700,000 displaced Palestinians were confined to crowded refugee enclaves in Gaza and the West Bank without sovereignty. Simultaneously, critical maritime waterways—the Suez Canal and the Straits of Tiran at Sharm el-Sheikh—became geopolitical flashpoints. Nasser's blockade of Israeli shipping directly precipitated the 1956 invasion, demonstrating how geography and maritime access dictated the rhythm of regional warfare.

1. THE PFC ANALYTICAL FORMULA (Q1 CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS])

STRICT 5-MINUTE EXAM TARGET

[P] POINT

Directly state the consequence using exact question phrasing.

[F] FACT

Provide precise historical evidence (exact dates, figures, casualties, names).

[C] CONSEQUENCE

Explain the long-term causal impact on regional tension or conflict.

2. HIGH-YIELD CAUSAL CONNECTIVES & BAND 4 EVALUATIVE CRITERIA

Analytical Causal Connectives:

- "Consequently, this fundamentally shifted..."
- "In direct reaction to this humiliation, Nasser..."
- "Crucially, this created an unresolvable deadlock because..."
- "This directly resulted in the military turning point whereby..."

Band 4 Evaluative Criteria Prompts:

- **Scale & Permanence:** Did this alter borders permanently (e.g. 1949 Green Line)?
- **Superpower Influence:** How did US or Soviet intervention dictate the outcome?
- **Demographic Impact:** How did displacement (Nakba) prevent diplomatic recognition?
- **Strategic Supremacy:** How did military factors overpower political agreements?

3. ANNOTATED GRADE 9 MODEL ANSWER • Q3: EXPLAIN IMPORTANCE [8 MARKS]

EXAMINER MARKS: 8/8 (BAND 4)

Question: Explain the importance of the bombing of the King David Hotel (July 1946) for the British decision to withdraw from Palestine.

Aspect 1 (Military & Administrative Destruction): The bombing of the King David Hotel on 22 July 1946 was of paramount importance because it directly crippled British military and civil administration in Mandatory Palestine. Militants from Menachem Begin's Irgun smuggled 350kg of explosives into the basement disguised as milk churns, detonating the entire south-west wing and killing 91 British, Arab, and Jewish staff. Crucially, this eradicated the central archives, intelligence registries, and senior command infrastructure of the British Secretariat. Consequently, the British army was forced into defensive, fortified enclaves ("Bevingrads"), demonstrating that Britain could no longer maintain basic law and order against determined Jewish insurgent militias.

Aspect 2 (Domestic Political & Financial Exhaustion): Furthermore, the bombing was decisively important in shattering British political resolve at home. Prime Minister Clement Attlee's postwar Labour government was financially bankrupt, rationing bread, and struggling under £3 billion of wartime debt while deploying 100,000 soldiers to Palestine. The public spectacle of British soldiers dying in a thankless imperial conflict triggered ferocious parliamentary and media backlash, crystallised by the execution of two British intelligence sergeants in retaliation for Irgun hangings in 1947. In direct reaction to this unsustainable financial drain and domestic fury, Foreign Secretary Ernest Bevin announced in February 1947 that Britain would abandon the Mandate and surrender the entire problem to the United Nations without enforcing a partition.

• Detailed historical facts: 22 July 1946, 350kg TNT, 91 deaths, Menachem Begin, 100,000 troops.

• Analytical focus: Direct link to Attlee's February 1947 UN surrender.

[illegible]

[illegible]

STUDENT ASSESSMENT RECORD • KEY TOPIC 1 TRACKER

Paper 2: Conflict in the Middle East, 1945–1995 • The Creation of the State of Israel (1945–1956)

PUPIL: _____	TARGET GRADE: 	PREDICTED: 	ATTITUDE: 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5
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#	ENQUIRY / LESSON ASSESSMENT	DO NOW (10M)	Q1(A) (4M)	Q1(B) (4M)	EXTENDED (8M)	LESSON TOTAL
1	KT1.1: Imperial Origins & Promises	[/ 10]	[/ 4]	[/ 4]	Q2: [/ 8]	[/ 26]
2	KT1.2: Mandate Collapse & King David	[/ 10]	[/ 4]	[/ 4]	Q3: [/ 8]	[/ 26]
3	KT1.3: UN Res 181 & The 1948–49 War	[/ 10]	[/ 4]	[/ 4]	Q2: [/ 8]	[/ 26]
4	KT1.4: Nakba & The Law of Return	[/ 10]	[/ 4]	[/ 4]	Q3: [/ 8]	[/ 26]
5	KT1.5: Nasser & The 1956 Suez Crisis	[/ 10]	[/ 4]	[/ 4]	Q2: [/ 8]	[/ 26]
KEY TOPIC 1 CUMULATIVE ASSESSMENT TOTALS		Do Now: [/ 50]	Q1(a): [/ 20]	Q1(b): [/ 20]	Ext: [/ 40]	[/ 130]

TEACHER FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT • WWW / EBI FEEDBACK		Effort Grade: []
WHAT WENT WELL (WWW):	EVEN BETTER IF (EBI):	
_____	_____	
_____	_____	
_____	_____	
_____	_____	
Teacher Signature: _____		Date: _____

INTERACTIVE DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • SCAN FOR INSTANT 20-QUESTION RETRIEVAL PRACTICE		Scan with smartphone camera to open live interactive 20-question self-marking quizzes		
KT 1.1: IMPERIAL PLEDGES Scan to Quiz Best Score: [/ 20]	KT 1.2: MANDATE COLLAPSE Scan to Quiz Best Score: [/ 20]	KT 1.3: UN 181 & 1948 WAR Scan to Quiz Best Score: [/ 20]	KT 1.4: NAKBA & STATEHOOD Scan to Quiz Best Score: [/ 20]	KT 1.5: NASSER & SUEZ 1956 Scan to Quiz Best Score: [/ 20]